shining spectacle of Darbar Sahib covered in gold. A reflection of its gilt-edged temple shimmered in the water of the holy pool that surrounded it. The surrealism of the view mesmerized me like always and I stood at the edge of the staircase, folding my hands in veneration, imitating Dada. Verses of Gurbani rang out in a comforting tune.

'Why are there four entrances, Maa?' I asked as we began our parikrama around the temple.

'It is because the temple is open from the four cardinal directions, so people can enter from any side, symbolizing openness towards all types of people,' Maa told me. 'Every person is equal, Gunjan beta, so everyone must have equal rights and privileges.' I returned a rather confused look. 'If I give a chocolate to Dada and not to you, would you like it?' she tried to simplify it. I shook my head. 'That is why we should treat everyone equally.'

We entered the langar hall, the community kitchen, and sat in line on the floor with all the other visitors. 'You see this? Everyone sits on the same floor and eats the same food. Regardless of whether you are a king or a beggar, you are treated alike here,' Maa continued our conversation from before.

'I understand, Maa,' I replied.

A volunteer poured daal on to our steel plates, another gave us chapatis, yoghurt and kheer. Simple but delicious. Papaji loved the kheer, and I enjoyed the daal.

We walked towards the temple after the langar. As we entered the queue of the main darbar, the hall, I saw a Sikh saint standing behind a huge bronze platter full of kadah prasad, asking visitors for their leaf bowls. I narrowed my eyes to see that he poured all of the kadah prasad from their leaf bowls into the platter and returned half of it in the same leaf bowl. 'Why does he take prasad from everyone, Maa?' reluctant to let him have our leaf bowl, I asked her.

'So that everyone's offerings are mixed together and everyone gets an equal share from the common platter. Remember what I told you—everyone must be treated equally,' Maa replied.